MYSORE DIOCESAN EDUCATIONAL SOCIETY

ST. PHILOMENA'S COLLEGE (Autonomous), MYSORE – 570 015

College of Excellence – UGC. Re-accredited by NAAC with B++ Grade

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DEPARTMENT OF BIOCHEMISTRY

REPORT ON

SESSION ON ENTREPRENEURSHIP AND ACCELERATOR/INCUBATION OPPORTUNITIES FOR STUDENTS AND FACULTIES

Theme: Startup

- **Activity Name**: Session on Entrepreneurship and Accelerator/Incubation Opportunities for Students and Faculties.
- **Mode of Conduct**: Offline
- **Date**: 18 August 2026
- **Level of Activity**: Level 1 (Half-Day Event)
- **Venue**: UG Auditorium, St. Philomena's College (Autonomous), Mysore
- **No. of Participants**: 98 (Students: 93, Faculty: 05)
- **Organized By**: Department of Biochemistry, St. Philomena's College (Autonomous), Mysore, in association with the Institution's Innovation Council (IIC).

Introduction: To bridge academia and industry, an insightful **session on accelerators/incubation** was organized by **Department of Biochemistry** in association with the **Institution's Innovation Council (IIC).** The session aimed to introduce students and faculty to key startup support structures, incubation networks, and practical pathways for turning innovative ideas into commercial ventures.



Formal inauguration

Objectives

1. To introduce students and faculty to the modern business ecosystem.
2. To explore entrepreneurship as a viable post-graduation career path.
3. To elucidate the journey from idea validation to scalable enterprise.
4. To outline the role of institutional incubators and accelerators in driving innovation.

Speaker: Mr. Rakesh Babu K.L

K.L. Rakesh Babu is COO & Executive Director at Innomantra. Innomantra works across innovation management and IP strategies, consulting for major global industry leaders such as Samsung, Bosch, Google, TATA, and many others.



Speaker: Mr. Rakesh Babu K.L, COO & Executive Director, Innomantra Consulting Pvt. Ltd.

Mr. Rakesh is a master innovation trainer who has designed and delivered highly acclaimed innovation engagement and training programs with several Global Fortune 500 firms. He specializes in training senior executives in the areas of innovation tools, collaborative innovation and innovation leadership. He has more than 20 years of experience in innovation management, entrepreneurship and marketing, and has been part of Design thinking programs by IDEO-U and Darden University.

He is a co-developer of the Functional Innovation Methodology, a systematic approach for product, process and business model innovation. He has worked with leading firms like ABB, NetApp, Cognizant Technology Solutions, Alcatel Lucent, BEL, Newell India, TE Connectivity, Bureau veritas and Larsen and Toubro in developing and designing result-driven innovation engagements.

He is an IBM certified 'Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner.' He has served as the Membership Vice-Chairman of the TiE Mysuru chapter. He was also a member of the Confederation of Indian Industry Information Technology panel for five consecutive terms, as well as part of the F&T panel. He has chaired numerous events and has been invited to speak at various platforms and institutions.

Session by Mr. Rakesh Babu K.L

Mr. Rakesh opened the session by giving a foundational overview of the business ecosystem, highlighting entrepreneurship as a compelling and viable career path after graduation or post-graduation. He emphasised the importance of developing innovative ideas that solve regular and complex societal challenges. Furthermore, he underscored that out-of-the-box thinking paired with strong communication skills is essential to transform creative concepts into a successful enterprise.

Key remarks and presentation highlights:

<u>The modern landscape & core skills</u>

- **Risk landscape**: Multi-domain global risks (economic, environmental, geopolitical, societal, and technological) as identified by the World Economic Forum, were highlighted.
- **Essential skills**: Great emphasis was placed on the World Economic Forum's top 10 skills required for today's competitive world, with complex problem-solving, out-of-the-box thinking, and continuous skill-building beyond academic curricula being prioritized.
- **Entrepreneurship mindset**: Resilience, global perspectives, tech integration, social/environmental responsibility, long-term strategic thinking, and ethical foundations were stressed as core elements of entrepreneurship.

<u>Understanding the Startup & Business Ecosystem</u>

- **Startup vs. Business**: A startup was defined as an entity driven by innovation, a scalable business model, and the potential for exponential growth.
- **Target market identification**: Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs was presented as a framework for mapping customer needs.
- **Business models**: Modern models, including Subscription-based, Freemium, Platform, On-demand Economy, Crowdsourcing/Crowdfunded, and Product-as-a-Service, were elucidated with suitable examples.
- **Funding & legal structures**: Business entities (Proprietorship, Partnership/LLP, Pvt. Ltd., Public Limited/IPO) and funding stages (Bootstrapping, Angel Investment) were explained. Intrapreneurship (building startups within existing companies) and real-world ecosystem examples (e.g., non-government space ventures backing ISRO, Airbnb, Razorpay) were also discussed.



Session in progress

Startup Frameworks & Incubator Guidelines

The speaker differentiated between incubation and acceleration programs and outlined the application process, placing special emphasis on eligibility requirements and selection criteria. Mr. Rakesh emphasized the importance of adopting the perspective of the selection panel when pitching an idea for incubator or accelerator support.

He detailed the core evaluation criteria used by selection panels, which include:

- A well-defined problem statement
- A clear value proposition
- A realistic market opportunity
- A capable and committed team
- Early traction or a functional prototype
- Coachability

Additionally, mentorship was identified as the highest-leverage support provided, alongside key funding and networking opportunities offered by these programs.



Q&A session

Actionable for Students & Faculty

- **Validate before building**: Progression must be directed from Problem → User Interviews → Prototype/MVP → Iterative Testing before large capital is sought.
- **Skill & network building**: Professional platforms (e.g., LinkedIn) should be joined to expand global connectivity, and active engagement with faculty mentors must be maintained.
- **Incubator readiness**: A concise one-page problem/solution summary should be prepared, target users must be clearly defined, and team commitment should be demonstrated when incubator applications are submitted.

Outcomes of the Session

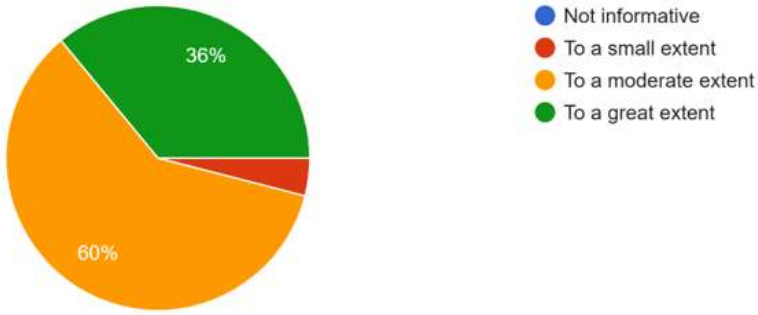
- **Ecosystem awareness**: Clarity was gained by participants regarding the practical progression from Idea → Validate → Build → Incubate → Launch → Scale.
- **Resource identification**: Institutional support mechanisms, including infrastructure, mentorship networks, legal/IP assistance, and seed funding routes, were clearly mapped.
- **Mindset shift**: Students were encouraged to view startup creation and intrapreneurship as viable, structured career opportunities post-graduation.



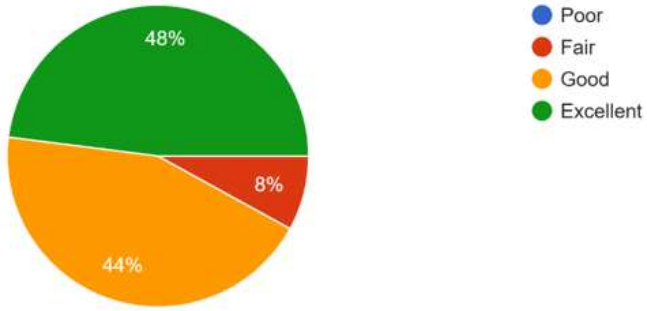
Mrs. Shruthi G (Assistant Professor & Head, Dept. of Biochemistry) presenting memento to Mr. Rakesh Babu K.L

Feedback summary
The summary of feedback collected from participants is as follows:-

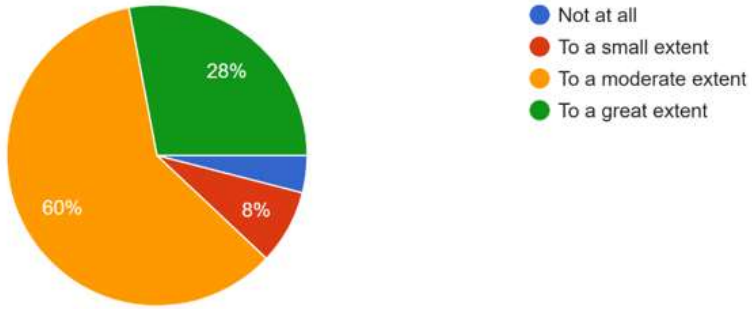
1. How informative was the session in helping you understand entrepreneurship and incubation opportunities?



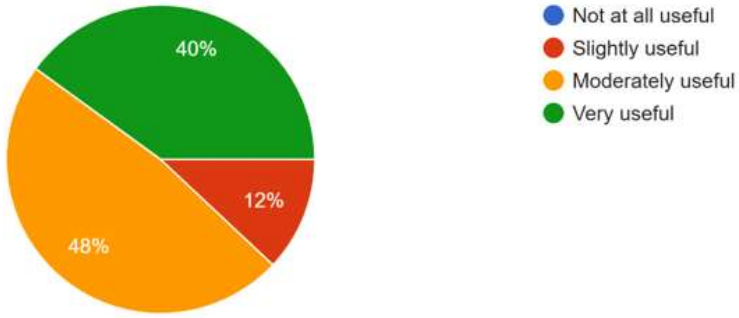
2. How would you rate the speaker's clarity, domain expertise, and ability to address participant queries?



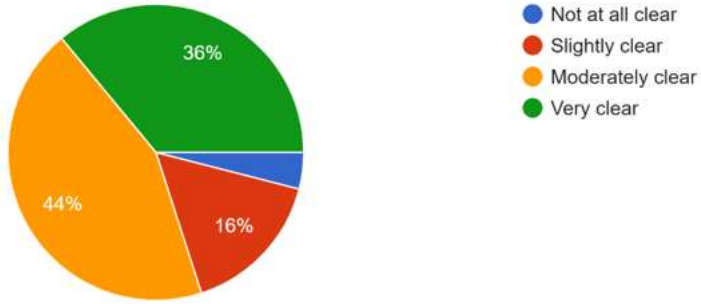
3. To what extent did this session increase your interest in pursuing entrepreneurship or utilizing campus incubation facilities



4. How useful did you find the resources/links/real-world startup examples shared during the session?



5. How clearly did the session outline the process of applying to incubation programs and the funding and networking opportunities offered through such programs?



Conclusion

The event successfully bridged the gap between academic innovation and real-world execution, leaving participants with a practical roadmap for entrepreneurial growth. The session equipped students and faculties with the strategic mindset, essential skills, and institutional awareness needed to transform ambitious ideas into impactful, scalable ventures.